

Polity 03 - Salient Features | ASCII Master Flowchart

PANEL 1/12 - ORIGIN: INHERITANCE -> CHOICE -> DESIGN -> DEVELOPMENT

1919 experiments -> Government of India Act 1935 machinery

-> nationalist rights, representation, social justice and sovereignty

-> Constituent Assembly 1946-49 adaptation

-> Constitution in force 1950

-> 7th/42nd/44th/61st/73rd/74th/86th/97th/101st changes

-> Kesavananda, Maneka, Minerva Mills, Bommai, Rajendra N. Shah

CONTROL: distinguish original features from later additions.

PANEL 2/12 - WHAT A FEATURE IS

Constitution creates + distributes + limits + directs public power.

FEATURE = interaction of provisions, institutions, values and practice.

CONSTITUTIONALISM = effective limits, accountability and remedies.

TRAP: salient feature != one Article != closed basic-structure list.

PANEL 3/12 - WRITTEN DETAIL AND CHANGE

1949: Preamble | 395 Articles | 22 Parts | 8 Schedules.

Current Article total: use dated/counting-qualified figure.

Why detailed: diversity | 1935 inheritance | Union-State framework | legal detail.

Change: simple majority outside 368 -> special majority -> plus half States.

LIMIT: no referendum; no joint sitting; no destruction of basic structure.

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PANEL 4/12 - BORROWED, ADAPTED, REJECTED

1935 Act -> federal/admin/judicial machinery -> colonial legitimacy rejected.
Britain -> cabinet/rule of law/single citizenship -> monarchy/sovereign Parliament rejected.
USA -> rights/review/VP -> presidentialism/dual citizenship/rigid separation rejected.
Ireland DPSP | Canada strong Centre | Australia Concurrent List
USSR Duties | France republic | South Africa amendment | Japan Article 21 wording.
VERDICT: genealogy of parts != identity of whole.

PANEL 5/12 - FEDERAL BALANCE

FEDERAL: two governments | lists | supremacy | rigidity | bicameralism | judicial umpire.
CENTRALISING: residuary power | Governors | single citizenship | integrated courts
All-India Services | emergency powers.
OPERATION: cooperative + competitive + asymmetric.
Article 1: Union of States; no secession compact.
LABELS: Wheare quasi-federal | Austin cooperative | Jennings centralising tendency.

PANEL 6/12 - PARLIAMENTARY RESPONSIBILITY

people -> Lok Sabha/Assembly -> PM/CM Council -> administration.
nominal + real executive | majority rule | collective responsibility
ministers in legislature | leadership | lower-House dissolution.
GAIN: coordination and daily accountability.
RISK: disciplined majority may produce executive dominance.
LIMIT: Indian Parliament is not Westminster-sovereign.

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PANEL 7/12 - CHECKS, RULE OF LAW AND SUPREMACY

Separation markers: Arts 50 | 121/211 | 122/212 | 361.

Overlap: ordinances 123/213 | delegated law | Article 368 | court rules/contempt.

Review: Arts 13/32/226 | responsibility: Art 75.

Ram Jawaya: no rigid separation.

Constitution supreme -> competence + fair procedure + rights + remedies.

Maneka: Article 21 procedure must be fair, just and reasonable.

PANEL 8/12 - JUDICIARY AND NORMATIVE TRIANGLE

Integrated hierarchy: SC -> HCs -> subordinate courts; Union + State law.

Independence: tenure/removal/service/finance + protected core function.

FR Part III = enforceable liberty/equality.

DPSP Part IV = non-justiciable welfare direction.

Duties Part IV-A/51A = civic responsibility.

Minerva Mills: Parts III-IV harmony; none of the three has identical legal status.

PANEL 9/12 - IDENTITY, DEMOCRACY AND INTEGRATION

sovereign | socialist | secular | democratic | republic.

42nd 1976 added Socialist/Secular/Integrity; commitments pre-dated words.

secularism = equal citizenship + conscience + principled engagement.

franchise from start; 61st 1988 lowers 21 -> 18.

single citizenship + integrated courts/services within federalism.

asymmetry accommodates territorial, tribal, cultural and linguistic difference.

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PANEL 10/12 - BODIES, EMERGENCIES, LOCAL GOVERNMENT, CO-OPS

ECI 324 | CAG 148-151 | PSCs 315-323 | Finance Commission 280 periodic.

352 war/external aggression/armed rebellion.

356 State constitutional failure; 365 may inform; Bommai review.

360 financial threat.

73rd: Part IX + 11th Schedule | 74th: IX-A + 12th.

97th: 19(1)(c) + 43B + IX-B; Rajendra N. Shah limits State field.

PANEL 11/12 - VERIFIED PYQ CONTROL

DIRECT MAINS: 2019 GS-II Q1 checks/balances | 2021 GS-II Q1 morality.

DIRECT PRELIMS: 2018 Q40/Q45 | 2020 Q7 | 2021 Q87/Q90/Q94

2023 Q33/Q84 | 2024 Q74.

KEY CONTROL: only 2024 Q74 = D from locally held final official Set-A key.

Every older objective: Answer withheld pending official UPSC key.

CLOSE TRAPS: Union not Federation | no strict separation | no national language
secular/socialist not original words | local bodies added later.

PANEL 12/12 - EXECUTABLE ANSWER SPINE

Thesis -> origin/adaptation -> form/change -> federal/parliamentary allocation

-> checks/review/rule of law -> rights/welfare/duties

-> franchise/citizenship/bodies/local democracy -> tension and limit

-> constitutional-morality verdict.

EVERY PARAGRAPH:

claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification/link.

FINAL: authority + restraint + representation + transformation;
constitutional practice decides whether the balance endures.